

Blest be the tie that binds

Text: John Fawcett, 1782, alt.

Music: Johann G. Nägeli, 1828; arr. Lowell Mason, 1845

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The musical score is written for guitar and voice. It consists of two systems of music. The first system has a treble clef, a key signature of two flats (B-flat and E-flat), and a 3/4 time signature. Above the staff are seven guitar chords: E-flat major (231), B-flat7 (1211), E-flat major (231), E-flat7 (1112), A-flat major (4132), E-flat major (231), and B-flat major (3211). The melody is written on a single staff with lyrics underneath. The second system continues the melody and lyrics, with ten guitar chords: B-flat7 (1211), E-flat major (231), B-flat major (3211), B-flat7 (1211), E-flat major (231), A-flat major (4132), E-flat major (231), A-flat major (4132), E-flat major (231), B-flat7 (1211), and E-flat major (231). The lyrics are as follows:

1 Blest be the tie that binds our hearts in Chris - tian love.
2 We share each oth - er's woes, each oth - er's bur - dens bear,
3 When we a - sun - der part, it gives us in - ward pain,
4 From sor - row, toil, and pain, and sin we shall be free,
The fel - low - ship of kin - dred minds is like to that a - bove.
and of - ten for each oth - er flows the sym - pa - thiz - ing tear.
but we shall still be joined in heart, and hope to meet a - gain.
and per - fect love and friend-ship reign through all e - ter - ni - ty.